WATTS UP WITH YOUR WELL-BEING?



If your home's illumination doesn't sync with your daily rhythm, from bright morning rituals to those that aid restorative sleep, you're missing 2026's ultimate lifestyle essential

By **ARYAMAN JAIN**

Good lighting is not noticed, but bad lighting is felt. Most people think lighting is about seeing. It isn't; lighting is about being. Long before alarms, calendars or screens existed—light guided the human body, telling it when to wake, when to focus and when to rest. This internal clock or our circadian rhythm, still governs how we sleep, think, digest and recover. Yet in most homes today, lighting remains indifferent to this rhythm.

Lighting is often treated as a decorative afterthought. Chosen late in the design process and reduced to fixture styles, wattage or ambience. Rarely is it designed around how people live. Human-centric lighting (HCL) changes that.

At its core, HCL is a simple idea-lighting that follows the natural progression of daylight. Morning light, cooler and brighter, supports alertness, hormone regulation and mental clarity. As the day progresses, balanced, glare-free light sustains focus without fatigue. By evening, warmer, and softer tones signal the body to slow down, release melatonin and prepare for rest.

When this rhythm is respected, we function better: sleep improves, energy stabilises, mood lifts, and